BUILDING A REGIONAL WORKFORCE INTELLIGENCE ECOSYSTEM

How Workforce Boards, Community Colleges, and Employers Co -Design Regional Strategy

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Meeting of the Minds Conference

September 8, 2026

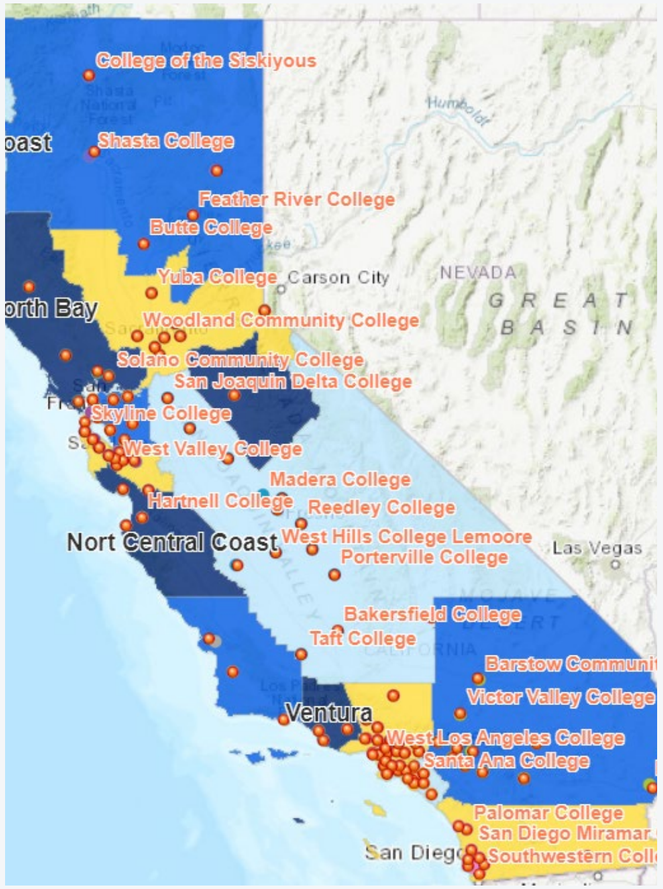
California already has everything on the list

- ✓ Workforce boards
- ✓ Community colleges
- ✓ Industry partnerships
- ✓ Labor market data
- ✓ State investments

So why can't we answer this?

Which three occupations should this region invest in next year, and who decides?

The problem is not a lack of programs.
It is a lack of shared intelligence.



Everybody measures success differently



What outcomes do different stakeholders measure?

Community colleges	Workforce boards	Economic development	Employers
Certificates	Certificates	Business growth	Hiring
Degrees	Employment	Site expansion	Retention
Completion	Earnings	Tax base	Skill readiness

Four scoreboards, one region, no shared definition of success.

What the Legislative Analyst's Office Found

Alignment Challenges

1

Fragmented regional planning

2

Duplicative employer engagment

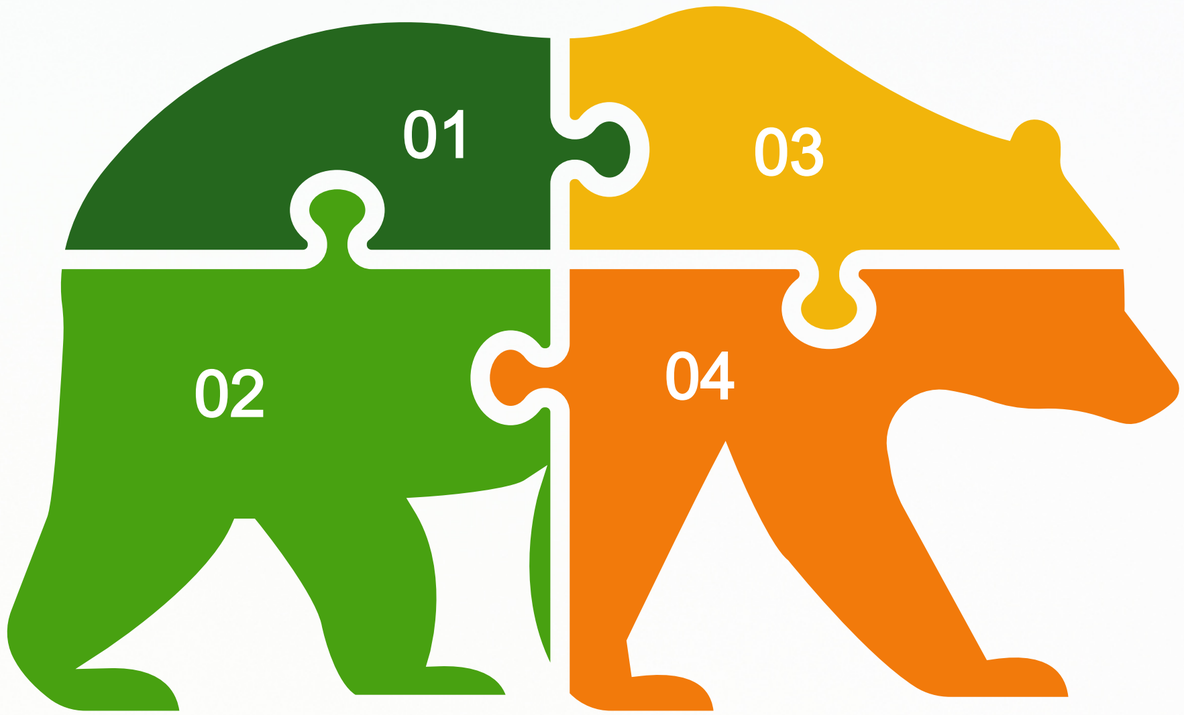
Accountability Challenges

3

Different measures

4

Unclear outcomes



The fault is not in our approach but in our alignment.

Assessment of the Strong Workforce Program (2025)

LIVE POLL

Who is in the room?

Where does your region stand?

1

Who owns employer intelligence in your region?

2

How do your partners collaborate?

THE WORKFORCE INTELLIGENCE ECOSYSTEM

Data + Employer Insight + Institutional Expertise =
Coordinated Regional Action



IN THEORY

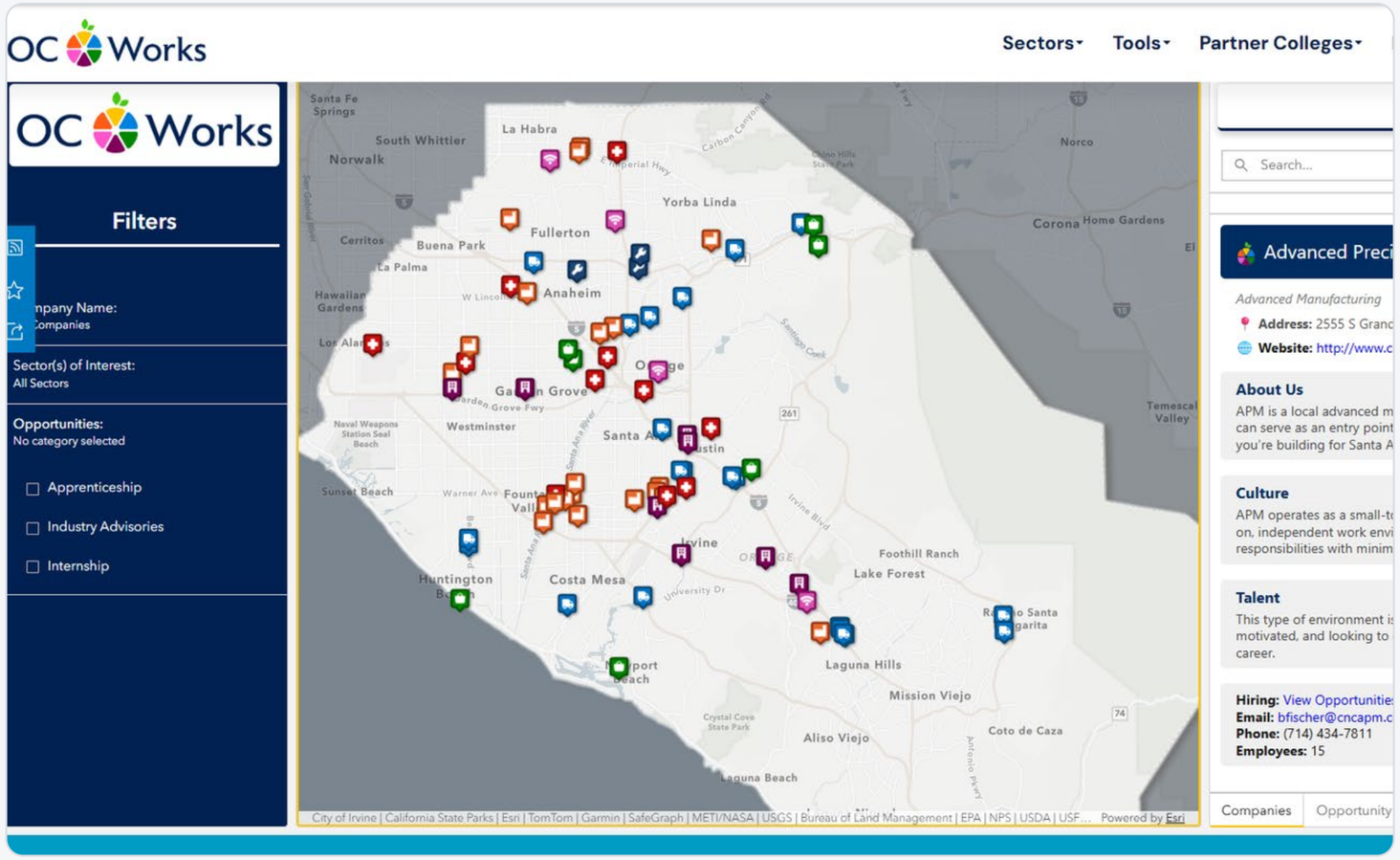
When we share intelligence, we make better decisions—and drive stronger outcomes for our region.

01

Find the employers

Location intelligence and the OC Works Hub

Mapping opportunities, building relationships



Employers on the map

Filter by sector, apprenticeship, internship, advisory

One record per employer

Address, hiring contact, culture, open roles

Shared by all partners

Colleges, board staff, and counselors work the same list

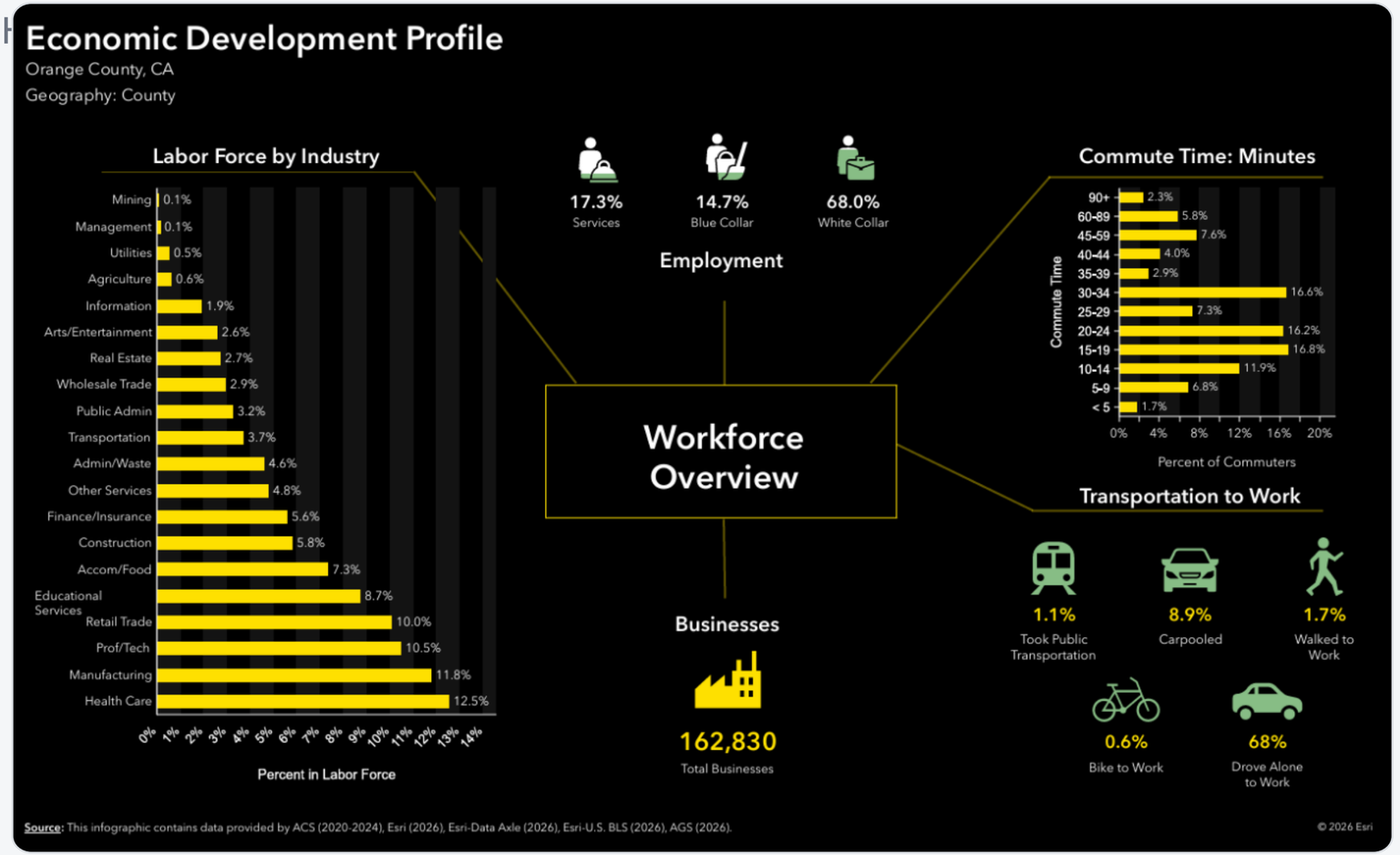
Built through outreach

Set goals 100 employers in 100 days

The data layer behind the map

ArcGIS Business Analyst and the OC Works H

1. Industry demand
2. Talent supply
3. Commuting patterns
4. Geographic opportunity gaps
5. Workforce participation trends



Counselors, faculty, and board staff use the same profile, so the conversation with a student and the conversation with a board start from one set of numbers.

02

Convene the employers

Regional advisories built on the BILT model

Employers co-lead. They do not just advise.

The Business and Industry Leadership Team model gives employers a structured, repeatable role in program decisions.

BILT Business & Industry Leadership Team

4

meetings a year

Three short trends calls plus one working session

1 to 4

skills vote

Employers rank every skill line by line, 1 drops it, 4 requires it

12 to 36

months ahead

They vote on what new hires will need, not what they needed last year

A vote produces a document. A document changes a syllabus. That is the difference.

How this differs from a standard advisory committee

	Advisory committee Title 5 baseline	BILT Program level	NextGen partnership Regional level
Agenda set by	College	College and employers	Industry leaders
Focus	Program compliance	One program's skills list	Whole industry
Meetings	1 to 2 per year	4 per year	Quarterly plus task teams
Output	Minutes and sign-off	Ranked skills list	Employer-led action
Members	Mixed representatives	Technical experts	Owners and CEOs
Horizon	Current year	12 to 36 months out	3 to 5 year vitality

An advisory committee satisfies a regulation. A BILT changes a syllabus. A sector partnership changes a regional strate

03

What changed

Automotive Technology and Culinary Arts

Employers: What Matters Most for Automotive Career Success

1

What skills top the list

- *OEM diagnostic systems and manufacturer-specific procedures*
- *Advanced troubleshooting and diagnostic reasoning*
- *Professional communication, documentation, and customer service*

2

What employers would like to change

- *More hands-on training and less theory-only instruction*
- *Stronger dealership and employer partnerships*
- *Increased access to current diagnostic equipment and technology*

3

What Accelerates Employment

- *Internships and work-based learning experiences*
- *Direct employer introductions and referrals*
- *Exposure to real workplace practices and dealership expectation*



Auto Tech Gap
5,000+ Statewide
800+ Orange

Focus Group Takeaway:

Strengthen employer partnerships and work-based learning to accelerate hiring and retention.

Employer Feedback to Improve Internship Experiences

1

What employers told us

- *Food safety preparation and production*
- *Guest service*
- *Teamwork and station leadership*

2

What we changed

- *Used employer skill rankings to validate and reinforce core culinary competencies*
- *Increased attention to internship structure and employer engagement*
- *Employer communication protocols and onboarding improvements*

3

What happened to students

- *3 students placed at BJ's Irvine through pilot internship program; scaling to additional sites*
- *Multiple sites interested in offering interns permanent positions after placement*
- *Employers praised students' food safety knowledge, professionalism, and workplace readiness*



BJ's RESTAURANT BREWHOUSE

Summer 2026

WHERE WE THINK THIS GOES NEXT

BILT Business & Industry Leadership Team

NEXT GENERATION SECTOR PARTNERSHIPS

How the two models could work together

We have not run it this way yet. NextGen is the room most of you already know, and this is the connection we are trying to build next.

NextGen sector partnership
Sets the priorities

WHO	Owners and CEOs across one industry
CONVENER	Workforce board, as neutral host
CADENCE	Quarterly, plus employer-led task teams
OUTPUT	Shared industry priorities, workforce and everything else

The sector table names the priority occupations

BOARD BROKERS

Programs report what they can and cannot supply

BILT program advisory
Turns priorities into programs

WHO	Hiring managers and technical experts
CONVENER	College, with the board brokering
CADENCE	Three short calls, one working session
OUTPUT	Ranked skills list, **12 to 36 months out**

Run the trends and report-back sessions once for the region. Only the employer skills session runs program by program.

1. **IDENTIFY TRENDS** — Sector partnership identifies industry trends and needs
2. **SET PRIORITIES** — Sector table agrees on priority occupations
3. **ALIGN & BROKER** — Board brokers connect priorities to college program input
4. **BUILD PROGRAMS** — BILT advisory turns priorities into ranked skills and programs
5. **REPORT & IMPROVE** — Report back to the region and repeat with new insights

ONE SYSTEM. Shared priorities. Stronger programs. Better outcomes for our region.

YOUR TURN

Which room is your region missing?

A	**A table for the whole industry**	Employers meeting as a sector, not as one program's advisors (NextGen)
B	**Employers ranking the skills**	A program asking employers what new hires will need next (BILT)
C	**The connection between them**	Both rooms exist and never talk to each other
D	**All three, honestly**	You have a compliance committee and a full calendar



What we have learned so far

We are not finished. This is where we are after two years.

1

Build co-leadership, then borrow the method

Employers, colleges, and the board setting priorities together is the goal. BILT and NextGen are both open and free to use, so take the pieces that fit your region.

2

Put one set of numbers in front of everyone

Shared data is what turns sector planning, program decisions, and investments into one conversation instead of four.

3

Connect the partners, not just the data

A shared picture only counts if it changes what partners decide together. Start by naming the room your region is missing, and protect employer time while you fill it.

OC Works

www.oc-works.org

Thank You

STAY IN TOUCH

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